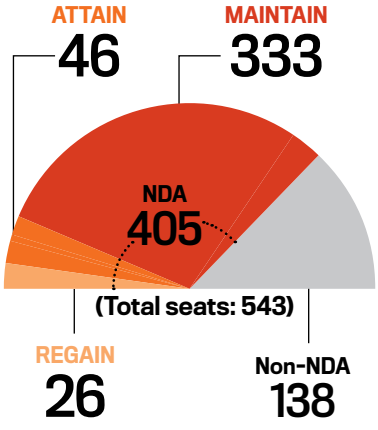
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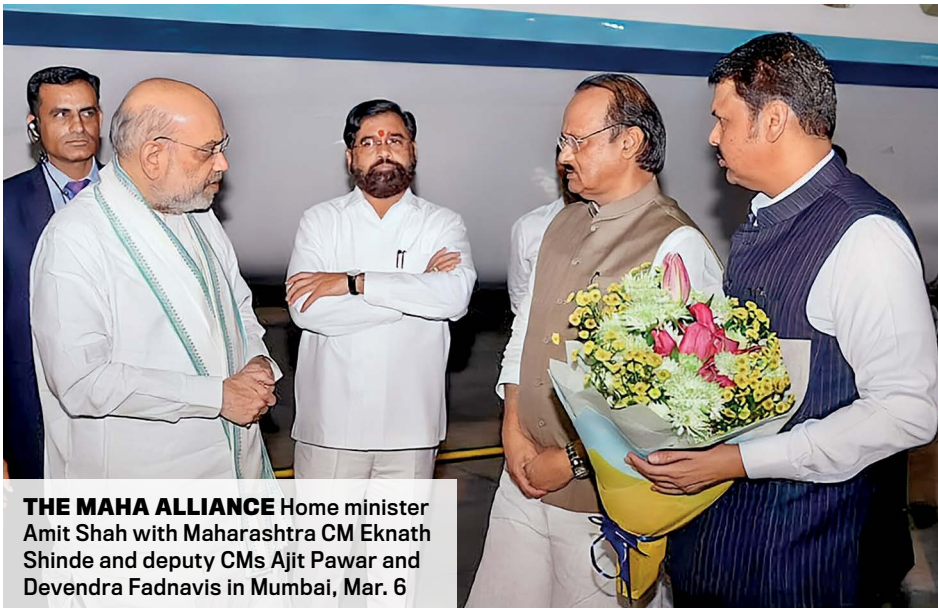
- The BJP must maintain a 100 per cent strike rate in the 303 seats it had won in 2019 (*see table below*)
- Its 2019 allies who are still in the NDA need a 67 per cent strike rate in their 44 seats to add another 30 seats and take the total to 333

STATE	SEATS
Uttar Pradesh	62
Maharashtra	23
West Bengal	18
Bihar	17
Madhya Pradesh	28
Chhattisgarh	9
Rajasthan	24
Delhi	7
Uttarakhand	5
Himachal Pradesh	4
Odisha	8
Karnataka	25
Telangana	4
Assam	9
Jharkhand	11
Gujarat	26
Haryana	10
Others	13
TOTAL	**303**

BEST-CASE SCENARIO

- If everything goes the BJP's way, it stands the chance to win up to 405 seats along with its allies
- These include 355 seats for the BJP and 50 for other NDA partners





THE MAHA ALLIANCE Home minister Amit Shah with Maharashtra CM Eknath Shinde and deputy CMs Ajit Pawar and Devendra Fadnavis in Mumbai, Mar. 6

IN MAHARASHTRA, BY ENGINEERING SPLITS IN THE SHIV SENA AND THE NCP, THE BJP NEUTRALISED THE THREAT POSED BY THE OPPOSITION-LED MVA. BUT THE PARTY MACHINATIONS MAY HAVE HURT *MAHARASHTRACHI ASMITA*, MAKING THE ELECTION OUTCOME UNCERTAIN

plank of a national census to counter the BJP's Hindutva push.

However, in a stunning coup in January 2024, the BJP got Nitish to dump the RJD and rejoin the NDA. In doing so, not only did it strike a body blow to the I.N.D.I.A. grouping, but also seemingly erased the backward class threat that could have challenged its attempt to consolidate the Hindu vote. The BJP also got the breakaway faction of the LJP headed by Chirag Paswan to return to the NDA. The party is now likely to contest 17 out of the 40 seats in the state, the same number as it did in 2019, leaving the JD(U) with 16, the LJP Chirag with five and the two parties that emerged out of the JD(U)—the HAM-S (Hindustani Awam Morcha-Secular) headed by Jitan Ram Manjhi and Upendra Kushwaha's Rashtriya Lok Morcha—with one seat each. Here too, however, the BJP needs to be wary of Tejashwi's growing popularity that could upset calculations in a few seats.

At the same time, the BJP has worked to destabilise states led by Opposition parties, which accuse it of misusing central agencies such as the Enforcement Directorate (ED), the Income Tax (I-T) department and the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) for political gain. Two Opposition chief ministers—Hemant Soren in Jharkhand (who chose to resign since) and Arvind Kejriwal in Delhi—are in jail under charges the central agencies have pressed. The BJP has also worked to shake Congress rule in Himachal Pradesh by getting six of the party's MLAs to defect, leaving the Sukhvinder Sukhu government precariously poised. The Congress also accuses the BJP of getting the I-T department to freeze 11 of its accounts, depriving them of funds.